Aashish Chhabra

Platform Engineering & Architecture Leader

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SUMMARY

Platform engineering and architecture leader with 12+ years of experience, spanning application development, large-scale data platform administration, and the design of automation, security and platform products other engineering teams depend on. Personally built the central CI/CD framework connecting 170+ repositories to automated, centrally-secured pipelines; service owner and technical lead of Kafka-as-a-Service, a managed multi-tenant Kafka platform for Airtel B2B Cloud customers. Provides line and functional leadership across Development and DevOps.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Lead Engineer, Data Techops — Xtelify Limited (formerly Bharti Airtel Limited)

Gurugram, India · Dec 2024 – Present

- Personally built and maintain a central, marker-file-driven CI/CD framework that connects 170+ repositories to automated build, test and security-scan pipelines.
- Led the cutover of image security scanning from Prisma Cloud to Wiz across 170+ repositories in one central change, with no repository-level work required from developers.
- Service owner and technical lead of Kafka-as-a-Service, a managed multi-tenant Kafka platform for Airtel B2B Cloud customers — architecture, technology choices (React, Spring Boot, Temporal, PostgreSQL, Redis, Helm, Jenkins, Argo CD), pull-request reviews, and service readiness.
- Contribute to the architecture and packaging of CDE (Converged Data Engine), Airtel's internal Data Mesh platform, as it is turned into a B2B Cloud service.
- Provide line and functional leadership across Development and DevOps — hiring, performance reviews, and technical direction.
- Use Claude Code for pull-request review, security and bug analysis, and frontend/backend consistency checks; lead the introduction of AI-assisted engineering practices across the team.

Lead Engineer — Bharti Airtel Limited → Xtelify Limited

Gurugram, India · Jun 2021 – Nov 2024

- Engineered and ran a 9-broker Kafka platform carrying ~40 Gbps of combined traffic (bytes in plus out, including replication), with dual authentication, automated rebalancing, and full observability.
- Set Airtel's Elastic Stack monitoring standards across VMs, bare metal and Kubernetes, and drove adoption.
- Led and contributed to the move from Docker Swarm and server installs to OpenShift; set up Spark Operator, Trino and JupyterHub for developer teams.
- Designed an early single-workflow CI/CD approach (2023), later rebuilt into the central framework above.

Senior Software Engineer — Bharti Airtel Limited

Gurugram, India · Sep 2019 – May 2021

- Sole administrator of the production Cloudera platform as it grew from ~15 to ~390 servers.
- Planned the CDH 5.8 → CDP 7.1.6 migration and replaced the NameNode server with no business downtime.
- Planned and deployed disaster recovery for the production platform.

Senior Software Engineer — NCR Corporation

Gurugram, India · Jan 2018 – Sep 2019

- Built and ran an Enterprise Data Lake on Hortonworks HDP end to end — installs, upgrades, Kerberos/Active Directory, Ranger, Sqoop/Hive pipelines, on-call support.

Software Engineer — Tech Mahindra

Pune, India · Jun 2014 – Dec 2017

- Built Java/JSP application screens and SQL reporting logic for an AT&T quotations system.
- Joined the pilot moving quotations data into Hadoop, then the AT&T Quotations Warehouse System — cluster planning, Sqoop/Hive/Oozie pipelines. Hortonworks HDP Certified Developer, 2017.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Platform & Big Data: Cloudera CDH/CDP, Hortonworks HDP, Apache Kafka, Apache Hive, SQOOP, Spark Operator, Trino, YARN, Zookeeper, Apache Airflow

DevOps & Delivery: Ansible, Jenkins CI/CD, Central CI/CD Framework (marker-file driven), Black Duck, Coverity, Wiz, Temporal, Argo CD, Helm

Cloud & Containers: OpenShift (OCP), Kubernetes, Docker Swarm, Docker, Microsoft Azure (AZ-900), Airtel B2B Cloud

Observability: Elastic Stack (ELK), Grafana, Prometheus, Kafka UI

Languages & Data: Python, Java, React, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, Redis, Shell Scripting, MySQL, Oracle SQL

Systems: RHEL/CentOS 7-8, Kernel Tuning, Systemd, Bare Metal Administration

AI-Assisted Engineering: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor

CREDENTIALS

Hortonworks HDP Certified Developer (2017); Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) (2024); IIM Indore — Management Development Programme (2024)

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Electronics and Communication Engineering — Global Institute of Technology, Jaipur (Rajasthan Technical University, Kota) (2010 – 2014)